Use ChatGPT to Sort Out the Money Questions While You're Paying for Mom's Care

Four prompts to lay out what care is costing, separate what you've been told from what you know, list the money decisions on the table, and sort your questions by who can answer them.

Where you are

Mom's care is being paid from her accounts every month. Someone said everything has to be spent before Medicaid can help. Someone else said to move money. You don't know which actions could create a problem, so you're afraid to do anything.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names and account numbers removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not know your state's Medicaid rules, judge eligibility, or give legal, financial, or insurance advice. Bring those questions to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional.

What you'll have at the end

You can show what care is costing, which money decisions are on the table, and the questions a professional has to answer before anyone acts.

A one-page list: What we know, What we don't know, Money decisions we're considering, and Questions we need answered, with who to ask.

Before you start

- The latest bill from the care provider, or your best figure for what care costs each month.
- A rough list of Mom's monthly income. Round numbers are fine.
- Any money decisions the family has made lately or is talking about. You don't need everything.

PROMPT 1

Lay out what care is costing right now

WHY THIS MATTERS

When a bill arrives every month, the total is easy to feel and hard to state. Anyone who helps you will ask what care costs, what comes in, and what is paying the difference. Having that on one page gives the conversation a starting point.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The latest bill from the care provider and a rough list of Mom's monthly income.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> My mother is receiving long-term care and we are paying for it now. Here is what I know about the cost and how it is being paid:

> [PASTE YOUR NOTES, WITH NAMES AND ACCOUNT NUMBERS REMOVED]
>
> Using only what I've written, sort it under four headings: WHAT CARE COSTS EACH MONTH, WHAT COMES IN EACH MONTH, WHAT IS PAYING THE DIFFERENCE, and I DON'T KNOW THIS YET. Do not estimate any figure I didn't give, do not project how long the money will last, and do not say anything about Medicaid rules. Then list the facts I'm missing as questions I could answer by looking at a bill or a statement.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The monthly picture in your own numbers, with the blanks labeled.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Fill in the blanks you can from the bills and statements you already have.

PROMPT 2

Separate what you've been told from what you know

WHY THIS MATTERS

When a parent needs care, everyone has a rule to offer about what has to be spent, what is safe, and what can be given away. Some of it may be right for your state and your situation, and some may not. The useful move is to write each one down as a question.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The things people have told you about Medicaid and money, and who said each one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are things people have told our family about paying for my mother's care and about Medicaid, with who said each one:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Make a three-column table: WHAT WE WERE TOLD, WHO SAID IT, and THE QUESTION TO ASK A PROFESSIONAL TO CONFIRM IT. Do not tell me whether any statement is true or false, and do not state any Medicaid rule, limit, or time period. Rules vary by state and by situation. If a statement would lead us to spend, move, or give away money, mark it ASK FIRST.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A list of things to confirm, with nothing treated as settled.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Move the ASK FIRST lines to the top of your question list.

PROMPT 3

Write down the money decisions on the table

WHY THIS MATTERS

While care is being paid for, money decisions come up one at a time: repaying a relative, selling a car, changing a name on an account, a product someone suggested. Each one is a question for a professional before it is a decision.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Any gifts, transfers, sales, purchases, or account changes the family has made lately or is talking about.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are the money decisions our family has made recently or is considering for my mother:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Make two lists: ALREADY DONE, with the date if I gave one, and BEING CONSIDERED. Next to each item, write one plain question to ask a professional about it. Do not say whether any item is allowed, wise, or a problem, and do not suggest any alternative or strategy. For anything involving insurance, an annuity, or another financial product, note that the question also belongs with a licensed insurance or financial professional.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Every money decision in one place, each with a question beside it instead of an answer.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Bring both lists, with their questions, to the professional conversation.

PROMPT 4

Sort your questions by who can answer them

WHY THIS MATTERS

Some questions you can answer from a statement. Others belong to a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, or a licensed insurance or financial professional. Knowing which is which is the point of this guide.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've organized about paying for my mother's care:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Give me one page with four headings: WHAT WE KNOW, WHAT WE DON'T KNOW, MONEY DECISIONS WE'RE CONSIDERING, and QUESTIONS WE NEED ANSWERED. Under the last heading, mark each question with who should answer it: family, a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, a licensed insurance or financial professional, or not sure. Do not answer the questions, do not classify any asset, and do not recommend any action.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One page you could hand to a professional and have them understand where things stand.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the page. It's the start of the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You've organized what you know and the questions that need a professional. The next step is the planning interview, which produces a free planning report you can bring to your Medicaid planner.

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